



Intel using drone technology to create the American flag (Image courtesy: Intel Corp.)

The challenges

It is interesting to note that marketing experts across the globe are hailing drone technology as the next big thing. However, the Indian industry will have to overcome a few challenges before the technology is adopted by brands at a mass level.

In the West, mostly Fortune 500 companies have been investing in exploring new channels of advertising. They understand the need to change with the times, and drone advertising definitely fits the bill. They understand that they are creating an extraordinary experience for their consumers, and such initiatives will be on the higher side of the costs. However, that is not the case with Indian marketers.

Brand expert Harish Bijoor feels that drone advertising will gain popularity in India only if the cost of the technology slashes significantly. He points out that, brands are successfully connecting with their consumers through traditional media such as broadcast, print and now digital and, hence, have not explored this technology in advertising.

Nevertheless, with Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) planning to come up with a clear set of guidelines, drone technology companies are expected to come up with more sophisticated versions of drones, thus making the existing ones a little cheaper in cost. **EFY**

—Purba Das

How Artificial Intelligence Is Shaping The Healthcare Industry

➤ **The need for Big Data analytics is huge, as it is expected to change the way healthcare works**

Back in 1970s, when MYCIN—an early backward chaining expert system for identifying bacteria that caused severe infections and for recommending the right dosage of antibiotics in accordance with the patient's body weight—was developed using AI in Stanford University, USA, healthcare experts knew they had achieved a milestone in the history of healthcare. Since then, there has been no looking back.

Enterprises have since been focusing on using AI in healthcare. "The global healthcare industry is making significant strides in the field of AI. There are many startups as well as large players like IBM and Google who are working in the space," says Dr Pinak Shrikhande, principal at HealthQuad, a venture capital fund that specifically invests in early-stage healthcare companies in India.

AI in India is gaining popularity as many startups have been mushrooming in the healthcare space.

Reading Big Data

Healthcare industry is probably one of the few industries that generates

enormous amounts of data. Thus, the need for Big Data analytics is huge, as it is expected to change the way healthcare works. Douglas Adamson, chief technology officer - CSO, Health Catalyst, says that, most of the data that is collected is not used entirely.

"In healthcare, we have large volumes of data coming in. Electronic medical records alone collect huge amounts of data. But neither the volume nor the velocity of data in healthcare is truly high enough to require Big Data today," he explains in his article published in Health Catalyst.

However, that does not mean that he is suggesting Big Data analytics to be written off completely. In fact, it is just the opposite. Let us talk about IBM Watson for Oncology. "IBM Watson for Oncology has an advanced ability to analyse the meaning and context of structured and unstructured data in clinical notes and reports that may be critical to selecting a treatment pathway. Then by combining attributes from the patient's file with clinical expertise, external research and data, the program identifies potential treatment plans for a patient," Dr Shrikhande points out.

Interestingly, world-renowned oncologist Dr Lukas Wartman, assistant director of cancer genomics at Washington University in St. Louis, USA, turned to Watson, IBM's AI system, to get rid of his own cancer, which he had developed while studying this disease. Dr Wartman had developed acute lymphoblastic leukemia, and



AI in healthcare